

4.5 How the real Encon platform is put together

- Your Cold Chain Log is a small, clean version of what we actually run. This session is where you find out how the real thing differs — and why.

You won't be opening the code in this session. This is a whiteboard conversation about architecture, which is genuinely the more useful way to learn a system for the first time. The hands-on code walkthrough comes in 4.7, once your repository access is granted.

Do

Book a session (allow around 90 minutes) with the tech lead or architect. Ask them to draw the platform out and talk you through:

- How a request flows end to end — a click in the portal, through API Gateway and Lambda, to DynamoDB, and back
- How that compares to what you built. What's the same, and what did they have to do that you didn't?
- How the environments work — development, staging, production — and how code moves between them
- How authentication works, and why the patient-facing forms site is handled differently from the staff portal
- How pharmacy data gets into the platform in the first place — the upload pipeline
- Where the Terraform lives and how it's organised at real scale
- What breaks most often, and how they find out

Come prepared

Write down at least five questions before the session. The best ones come from comparing your own project to the real thing:

- "I used one table — how many do you have, and why?"
- "I put my alert on a queue. Where do you use queues, and what for?"
- "How do you handle a change to a table's keys once there's real data in it?"
- "What would happen if my `{{getReadingStatus}}` rule was wrong in production — how would you find out?"

Done when

- You can draw the platform's main pieces from memory and explain what each one does

- You've written into the worksheet three specific ways the real system differs from yours, and why
- Your remaining questions are written down with a plan for who to ask

Stuck?

"Why is it done this way?" is the best question you can ask in this session. There's usually a reason, and it's usually not written down anywhere.